3. HTML — Formatting and phrase tags

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These elements describe the text. `<b>` and `<i>` are part of current HTML. `<strong>` and `<em>` add importance and stress.

Bold and strong

`<b>` sets a span of text in a different voice without extra importance, such as a product name in a sentence. `<strong>` marks text that is important.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Bold Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <p>The item is a <b>samosa</b>.</p>
  <p><strong>Last order is 8:00 pm.</strong></p>
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

The item is a **samosa**.

Last order is 8:00 pm.

Italic and emphasis

`<i>` sets off a span in an alternate voice, such as a term or a name. `<em>` stresses a word.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Italic Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <p>The term <i>markup</i> means tags in a document.</p>
  <p>Please <em>collect</em> the token before 8 pm.</p>
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

The term *markup* means tags in a document.

Please *collect* the token before 8 pm.

Underline, strike, small, and mark

`<u>` marks text with a non-textual annotation, such as a spelling flag. `<s>` marks text that is no longer accurate. `<small>` is a side comment, such as fine print. `<mark>` highlights text that is relevant in the current context.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Underline Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <p>Check the spelling of <u>recieve</u>.</p>
  <p>The old price is <s>₹12</s>.</p>
  <p><small>Prices include GST.</small></p>
  <p>Search hit: <mark>samosa</mark> is in stock.</p>
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

Check the spelling of recieve.

The old price is ~~₹12~~.

Prices include GST.

Search hit: samosa is in stock.

Superscript and subscript

`<sup>` is superscript. `<sub>` is subscript.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Superscript Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <p>See the fee note<sup>1</sup>.</p>
  <p>H<sub>2</sub>O</p>
```

```
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

See the fee note[1].

H_2O

Inserted and deleted text

`<ins>` marks text added in a revision. `<del>` marks text removed. `datetime` records when the change was made.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Inserted Text Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <p>Tea is <del datetime="2026-09-01">₹12</del> <ins datetime="2026-09-20">₹15</ins>.</p>
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

Tea is ~~₹12~~ ₹15.

Phrase tags

Element	Purpose
`<abbr>`	An abbreviation. `title` holds the expanded form
`<dfn>`	The defining instance of a term
`<bdo>`	Overrides the text direction. `dir` is `ltr` or `rtl`
`<bdi>`	Isolates a span whose direction is unknown, such as a username
`<blockquote>`	A quotation of a paragraph or more. `cite` is the source URL
`<q>`	A short quotation inside a sentence
`<cite>`	The title of a work

Element	Purpose
`<code>`	Computer code
`<kbd>`	Input from a keyboard
`<samp>`	Sample output from a program
`<var>`	A variable
`<address>`	Contact information for the page or the article
`<time>`	A date or time. `datetime` is the machine-readable value
`<data>`	A value paired with human-readable text. `value` is the machine-readable value

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Phrase Tags Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <p><abbr title="HyperText Markup Language">HTML</abbr> describes structure.</p>
  <p>A <dfn>paragraph</dfn> is one block of text.</p>
  <p><bdo dir="rtl">This line is right to left.</bdo></p>
  <p>User <bdi>إيمان</bdi> joined the batch.</p>
  <blockquote cite="https://html.spec.whatwg.org/">
    <p>HTML is the World Wide Web's core markup language.</p>
  </blockquote>
  <p>Priya said <q>Save the file as index.html.</q></p>
  <p><cite>HTML</cite>, living standard.</p>
  <p>Save the file as <code>index.html</code>.</p>
  <p>Press <kbd>Ctrl</kbd> + <kbd>S</kbd>.</p>
  <p>The terminal printed <samp>Saved index.html</samp>.</p>
  <p>Set <var>qty</var> to the number of plates.</p>
  <p>Batch starts <time datetime="2026-10-06">6 October 2026</time>.</p>
  <p>Fee <data value="25000">₹25,000</data>.</p>
  <address>
    Placement cell<br>
    <a href="mailto:placement@ksr.example">placement@ksr.example</a>
  </address>
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

HTML describes structure.

A *paragraph* is one block of text.

.tfel ot thgir si enil sihT

User إيان joined the batch.

> HTML is the World Wide Web's core markup language.

Priya said “Save the file as index.html.”

HTML, living standard.

Save the file as `index.html`.

Press `Ctrl` + `S`.

The terminal printed `Saved index.html`.

Set *qty* to the number of plates.

Batch starts 6 October 2026.

Fee ₹25,000.

Placement cell
placement@ksr.example